

Check the Facts

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: Check the Facts is a DBT emotion-regulation skill: many emotions are driven by our thoughts and interpretations rather than the event itself. Examine the facts to see whether the emotion fits, then decide how to respond.

The event (just the facts, like a camera would record):

What emotion am I feeling, and how intense (0–100)?

What am I assuming or interpreting about the event?

What are the facts that support my interpretation?

What are the facts that do NOT support it? Is there another explanation?

Am I assuming a threat? How likely is the outcome I fear, really?

Does the emotion (and its intensity) fit the facts?

- ☐ Yes — the emotion fits; problem-solve or accept.
- ☐ No / partly — practice opposite action and re-check the facts.

My next skillful step: